

Giovanna Ferrari

GRADUATE STUDENT IN MARRIAGE, COUPLE & FAMILY COUNSELING

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ABOUT ME

Graduate student in Marriage, Couple and Family Counseling at Duquesne University, practicing artist, and former product designer with a growing focus on art activities and expressive approaches to emotional well-being. I enjoy creating opportunities for people to connect, communicate, and express themselves through creativity, and have experience facilitating art workshops and volunteering with art activities for patients in senior healthcare communities. I bring a thoughtful, compassionate, and collaborative approach, with strengths in active listening, organization, facilitation, and creating welcoming spaces where people feel comfortable participating and expressing themselves.

EDUCATION

M.S., Marriage, Couple & Family Counseling · Duquesne University In Progress
CACREP-accredited program · Counselor Education & School Psychology

Laurea in Public Relations · IULM University, Italy 2001

ART & CREATIVE PRACTICE

Artist & Creative Practitioner · Independent Artist · Pittsburgh, PA 2020–Present

- Maintain an independent studio practice focused on contemporary painting and expressive visual exploration.
- Develop and exhibit original artwork through independent and community-based exhibitions.
- Manage creative projects from concept development through production, presentation, communication, and promotion.
- Use painting and visual expression to explore inner experiences, emotions, and the stories we carry with us.
- Participate in the Pittsburgh arts community through exhibitions and creative programming.

ART ACTIVITY & COMMUNITY VOLUNTEERING

Art Activity Volunteer · Jewish Association on Aging · Pittsburgh, PA Summer 2024

- Provided art classes and art-based activities for individuals living with dementia.
- Used creative engagement to encourage self-expression, connection, and participation.
- Supported participants with patience, empathy, and individualized attention.
- Observed how creative activities can facilitate communication and emotional expression when verbal communication is difficult.

PRODUCT DESIGN / UX LEADERSHIP

Cisco Systems · Anthem · Uber ATG · PNC Bank 2009–2026

- 18+ years of experience collaborating with multidisciplinary teams, conducting research, facilitating workshops, and communicating complex information.
- Extensive experience interviewing people, synthesizing qualitative information, and translating diverse perspectives into actionable recommendations.
- Developed strong organizational, communication, presentation, and project-management skills through work across technology, healthcare, education, and financial services.

STRENGTHS & INTERESTS

Strengths: Interpersonal communication · Active listening · Facilitation · Organization · Collaborative work · One-on-one support · Public engagement · Project coordination

Interests: Art activities · Expressive modalities · Dementia care · Emotional expression · Community-based arts